depend on the proper functioning of the state. They should not take this for granted.

A healthy competition between officials who want to keep secrets and journalists who try to find them out is the hallmark of a democracy. My side winning this contest can involve notional or real breaches of the law, which may in turn expose journalists and their sources to the risk of prosecution. That is part of the job: a journalist who wants to invoke a public-interest defence in breaching secrecy has to be willing to plead his case before a judge and jury if necessary. If convicted, he will hope that political pressure will bring a pardon, or that history will vindicate him. We journalists do not enjoy absolute statutory immunity, nor should we. Nobody elected us. We make mistakes, and if they are bad ones—reflecting recklessness or malice—we should expect to suffer consequences. In short, both sides in this contest between truth and secrecy need to be guided by their sense of broader responsibility. Not every breach of official secrets deserves prosecution. And not every official secret deserves to be exposed.

Some of the accusations made against the Snowden camp are silly. It is not disloyal for journalists to try to expose state malfeasance. Nor is wrong for them to profit from their discoveries. Good journalists with good skills and good sources get good information, and if they are good at analysing and explaining it, they deserve (and may even get) good money.

Finally, worries about the future of privacy in an age of limitless electronic storage, powerful algorithms and extraordinary processing power are understandable. My forthcoming book *Cyber-phobia*[5] deals in detail with how our habits and attitudes need to evolve to match the rapid change of technology we use in our daily lives. In brief, my argument is for concern rather than panic. Society has evolved in the past in response to new technologies and the benefits and threats they bring. It will do so in the future too. We will find new ways of